

Chapter 90-2

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After parting with Gu Yixue, Liang Shi held the lighter she had given her and idly clicked it a few times.

A cluster of faint blue flames lit up, and a light smell of lighter fluid permeated the air.

"You're a grown adult and still playing with fire." Zhao Ying had just come out for some fresh air and smiled when she saw her actions.

Liang Shi put away the lighter. "Just playing around."

"Do you smoke?" Zhao Ying asked.

Liang Shi shook her head: "No."

"Then why are you carrying a lighter around?"

"I just ran into someone." Liang Shi said: "That person gave it to me."

Zhao Ying raised an eyebrow and smiled: "Your social circle is quite wide—you can even run into acquaintances here."

"It's a director." Liang Shi thought for a moment and described the person's features, then asked Zhao Ying, "Who is she?"

"You don't know her name?" Zhao Ying was puzzled.

Liang Shi said: "She told me one, but I searched online before and couldn't find anything, so I suspect it's a fake name."

Zhao Ying turned and asked a staff member who happened to be coming out: "Besides us, which other production is having a gathering here today?"

The staff member was a bit dazed from drinking, paused for a moment, then answered: "The 'Blind Eyes' production—Director Guila's ten-episode short series."

"Guila?" Zhao Ying said the name, frowned and repeated it, then suddenly understood. "You mean Quella?"

The staff member smiled embarrassedly: "Yes, that's the name."

Guila was the Chinese transliteration of this director's name, while her stage name was Quella.

Zhao Ying was surprised: "You actually know her."

"I happened to run into her last time and lent her a light." Liang Shi said.

Zhao Ying nodded and patted her shoulder: "You should stay in touch with her more. This director is really something."

"Hm?" Liang Shi was confused.

But Zhao Ying had already turned and walked away, leaving a reminder: "Search her up and you'll know."

This time Liang Shi searched for Quella, and results came up quickly.

The introduction following this name read: International emerging director, Bosca Best New Director, W.T Best Screenwriter. Representative works include "The Messenger," "The Postman," "The Trek" trilogy, "Lonely Angel," and "Fooling Around." Currently filming "Blind Eyes" and "Heart's Journey."

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Liang Shi clicked in with disbelief, then backed out in shock.

The award system in this world was somewhat different from her original world, but there were basic equivalents.

The Bosca Award was equivalent to the Oscars—the supreme honor for directors worldwide. And Gu Yixue was only twenty-nine years old this year.

When she won the Bosca Best New Director award—she was 21.

The W.T Best Screenwriter award was the world's TOP 1 in terms of prestige. The whole world expressed admiration for this Chinese director.

And she was also the youngest screenwriter in W.T history. The year she won—she was 19.

It had to be said, geniuses really did exist in this world.

The year Quella burst onto the international film scene, it triggered a huge wave of art film productions domestically.

But basically all of them returned in defeat.

Art films were easy to make—small budget, small production, you could make one with just tens of millions, filming mountains, water, and hazy emotions.

But making a good one was too difficult.

Yet the film Quella won the award for happened to be the cream of the crop among art films.

Liang Shi had actually seen it. After watching it at the time, she was filled with emotions and couldn't even figure out where to begin writing her thoughts.

She never would have imagined it was directed by Gu Yixue.

Online, there was no Chinese name for her either, only the transliterated name.

Inside Liang Shi's heart, ten thousand horses galloped past, roaring by.¹

Gu Yixue... just from hearing the name, you could tell she was someone who made art films.

Liang Shi stood there thinking—was it too late to go ask for her contact information now?

In the end, Liang Shi still didn't go ask.

She returned to the "Mo Guang" production's gathering with a slight feeling of regret.

The reason it was only slight regret was because she had missed such an excellent film director.

But the emotion wasn't serious.

Liang Shi knew that good directors, in order to find the actors they wanted, might look through thousands of actor profiles in a single day. Once they found someone they liked, they would check that person's schedule no matter what.

But Gu Yixue had only returned the lighter to her. Even after learning she was an actress, she didn't ask for her contact information, which meant there was no role she wanted her to play.

So there was nothing to regret.

If there was an opportunity in the future, perhaps they could collaborate.

After Liang Shi returned, she continued sitting in the corner. But the director noticed her sitting alone and came over with a wine glass to greet her.

The director, who had drunk a bit too much, kept praising her, saying that on the day Liang Shi auditioned, she had surprised everyone. You couldn't tell at all that she was someone who had just started acting, which meant she was naturally suited for this line of work.

Listening to the director's praise, Liang Shi thought of the information she had just looked up and suddenly felt ashamed of her own inadequacy.

The person truly suited for this line of work was Gu Yixue!

That was someone who was naturally born for this industry.

Liang Shi was just barely scraping by in this field. Suddenly, she felt like her own talent couldn't even be called talent anymore.

But the director still thought her performance was stunning.

Sitting there unable to refuse, she had a few more drinks with the director.

After the director left, Yan Xi suddenly came over: "Is your acting really stunning? How stunning?"

Liang Shi: "...I can only say it's moderately good."

Yan Xi made a dismissive sound, then said with a little pride: "Don't drag me down, okay?"

Liang Shi: "...I'll try. But have you acted before?"

Yan Xi thought for a moment: "Does filming an MV count?"

Liang Shi nodded: "Barely counts."

"Then I've barely acted before." Yan Xi said: "I've had super strong learning abilities since I was little. Otherwise, I wouldn't have gotten into Qingyi University. Just like Senior Sister Xu—if you don't believe me, go ask. There's nothing we can't learn."

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi held a skeptical attitude but very firmly gave her a few perfunctory responses.

Footnotes:

¹ **Ten thousand horses galloped past (萬馬奔騰):** A Chinese internet slang expression describing a state of extreme shock, disbelief, or mental chaos. The full phrase often implies "ten thousand grass mud horses galloping past," where "grass mud horse" (草泥馬) is a homophonic pun for a vulgar expletive, used to express speechlessness or exasperation.